



Nanotech India 2011

have embarked on a tri-lateral initiative to develop collaborative programmes in several common areas of interest, and nanotechnology being one of them. The International Science and Technology Directorate (ISAD) of the CSIR that aims

to strengthen cooperation between CSIR and international institutions has facilitated workshops and collaborative projects with international partners like South Africa, France, South Korea, China, Japan in the area of nanoscience and technology. Another forum for international collaboration is the Euro-India Net set up under the FP6 between EU and India to encourage collaborations between scientists from the two regions in the area of nanotechnology. A memorandum of understanding also has been signed between India and UNESCO to establish a Regional Centre for Education and Training in Biotechnology, where one of the focus areas is on nano biotechnology.

New kid on the block - Israel

The Israeli government set up the Israeli National Nanotechnology Initiative, with a mission to make nanotechnology the next big thing in industry by leading the way with a variety of initiatives. The INNI has launched partnerships among government, academia, and industry that will allow Israel to step up to the plate in the broader world of nanotechnology. The Israel Nanotechnology Trust is the part of the INNI that raises and distributes money. The Consortium for Nano Functional Materials (NFM) consists of participants from 14 industries and 12 academic research groups which are performing basic R&D in the field of nano-materials and technologies.

According to INNI estimates, Israel needs to invest at least \$300 million in research and development and to get hold on this kind of funding, the INT is looking at a variety of sources, including Jewish organizations. Traditionally, money from Jewish groups went towards supporting immigration to Israel, helping to develop agriculture, and building up military strength. The message that is being presented to Jewish donors is that an emphasis on funding science and